

Guide to beating resume screening algorithms and getting past ATS to human reviewers — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

EXTRACT KEYWORDS

- ☐ **Extract Keywords:** Copy the entire job posting into a document and highlight every hard requirement using the exact phrasing from the posting.
- ☐ **Extract Keywords:** Identify every soft preference phrase in the job posting by looking for words like 'preferred,' 'ideal,' or 'nice to have.'
- ☐ **Extract Keywords:** Research 3-5 LinkedIn profiles of people currently working in your target role at similar companies to find industry shorthand not in the posting.
- ☐ **Extract Keywords:** Build a master keyword list combining all three layers of language with every term appearing somewhere in your resume.

QUANTIFY YOUR DATA

- ☐ **Quantify Your Data:** Replace vague descriptions like 'led a team that improved customer satisfaction' with specific numbers and measurable outcomes.
- ☐ **Quantify Your Data:** Add specific metrics to accomplishments by including percentages, dollar amounts, timeframes, and team sizes.
- ☐ **Quantify Your Data:** Use ATS-friendly formatting by placing numbers and data points in plain text rather than embedded in graphics or tables.
- ☐ **Quantify Your Data:** Frame soft skills with hard evidence by following claims like 'project management' with concrete examples of project scope.

STRUCTURE FOR PARSING

- ☐ **Structure for Parsing:** Use standard section headers like 'Work Experience' and 'Education' instead of creative titles that ATS systems cannot categorize.
 - ☐ **Structure for Parsing:** Place the most important keywords in the top third of your resume where ATS systems weight them most heavily.
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- ❑ **Structure for Parsing:** Submit your resume in plain text or .docx format to ensure the ATS parser can extract your content accurately.
- ❑ **Structure for Parsing:** Avoid headers, footers, columns, and text boxes that ATS systems cannot parse correctly.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.